



Senate

General Assembly

File No. 342

February Session, 2026

Substitute Senate Bill No. 236

Senate, April 2, 2026

The Committee on Transportation reported through SEN. COHEN of the 12th Dist., Chairperson of the Committee on the part of the Senate, that the substitute bill ought to pass.

AN ACT IMPLEMENTING THE RECOMMENDATIONS OF THE CONNECTICUT AIRPORT AUTHORITY REGARDING THE LICENSURE AND REGISTRATION OF AIRPORTS AND OTHER AIR NAVIGATION FACILITIES.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Assembly convened:

1 Section 1. Section 13b-46 of the general statutes is repealed and the
2 following is substituted in lieu thereof (*Effective October 1, 2026*):

3 (a) The executive director may approve airports, heliports, vertiports,
4 restricted landing areas and other air navigation facilities. Any
5 municipality or person acquiring property for the purpose of
6 constructing or establishing an airport, heliport, vertiport or restricted
7 landing area shall, prior to such acquisition, apply to the executive
8 director for a certificate of approval of the site selected and the general
9 purpose or purposes for which the property is to be acquired, to ensure
10 that the property and its use shall conform to minimum standards of
11 safety and shall serve the public interest. Any proposed airport,
12 heliport, vertiport, restricted landing area or other air navigation facility

13 at which more than thirty-six landings and takeoffs are expected to be
14 made by aircraft in any year shall be approved by the executive director
15 before it shall be licensed to be used or operated. The executive director
16 shall make no charge for approval certificates of proposed property
17 acquisition for airport, heliport, vertiport or restricted landing area
18 purposes.

19 (b) The executive director may (1) license [airports, heliports,
20 vertiports, restricted landing areas and other air navigation facilities]
21 any airport, heliport, vertiport, restricted landing area and other air
22 navigation facility at which more than thirty-six landings and takeoffs
23 are expected to be made by aircraft in any year, and (2) renew such
24 licenses. When a certificate of approval of an airport, heliport, vertiport,
25 [or] restricted landing area or other air navigation facility has been
26 issued by the executive director, the executive director may grant a
27 license for operation and use. On and after [July 1, 1995] October 1, 2026,
28 the executive director shall charge a fee of [one hundred fifty] three
29 hundred dollars for each license or renewal thereof. Each such license
30 shall be effective for a period of three years from the date of issuance.
31 Each licensee shall certify, on a form provided by the executive director,
32 that the licensed facility shall comply with all applicable federal, state
33 and local laws and regulations during the license period. Municipalities
34 shall be exempt from the payment of any license fee in connection with
35 airports owned or operated by such municipalities.

36 (c) The executive director may (1) register any airport, heliport,
37 vertiport, restricted landing area or other air navigation facility at which
38 thirty-six or fewer landings and takeoffs are expected to be made by
39 aircraft in any year, and (2) renew such registrations. On and after
40 October 1, 2026, the executive director shall charge a fee of one hundred
41 dollars for each registration or renewal thereof. Each such registration
42 shall be effective for a period of three years from the date of issuance.
43 Each registrant shall certify, on a form provided by the executive
44 director, (A) that the registered facility shall comply with all applicable
45 federal, state and local laws and regulations during the registration
46 period, and (B) that there will be thirty-six or fewer landings and

47 takeoffs by aircraft at such facility in any year during the registration
 48 period. Any airport, heliport, vertiport, restricted landing area or other
 49 air navigation facility at which thirty-six or fewer landings and takeoffs
 50 are expected to be made by aircraft in any year shall be registered with
 51 the executive director pursuant to this subsection before it is to be used
 52 or operated. Municipalities shall be exempt from the payment of any
 53 registration fee in connection with airports owned or operated by such
 54 municipalities.

55 [(c)] (d) No municipality or officer or employee thereof and no person
 56 shall operate an airport, heliport, vertiport, restricted landing area or
 57 other air navigation facility for which approval has not been granted,
 58 and a license has not been issued, by the executive director in
 59 accordance with the provisions of subsection (b) of this section or
 60 registration has not been issued by the executive director in accordance
 61 with the provisions of subsection (c) of this section. The provisions of
 62 this section shall not apply to any airport, heliport, vertiport, restricted
 63 landing area or other air navigation facility owned by the federal
 64 government within this state. Any person who violates the provisions
 65 of this subsection shall be guilty of a class C misdemeanor.

66 [(d)] (e) Any heliport in operation prior to October 1, 1985, shall be
 67 deemed licensed for operation and use and the executive director shall
 68 issue an original license for any such heliport upon the written request
 69 of the person who controls and operates such heliport. Such heliports
 70 shall be subject to the provisions of this chapter concerning the renewal
 71 or revocation of licenses, inspection and review of air navigation
 72 facilities and any other provision of this chapter except those concerning
 73 the initial approval or licensing of such facilities. Such heliports shall be
 74 subject to any rule or procedure adopted by the authority in accordance
 75 with the provisions of this chapter except those concerning the initial
 76 approval or licensing of any air navigation facility.

This act shall take effect as follows and shall amend the following sections:		
Section 1	October 1, 2026	13b-46

Statement of Legislative Commissioners:

In Subsec. (b), "airports, heliports, vertiports, restricted landing areas and other air navigation facilities" was changed to the singular for consistency, and in Subsec. (d), "was not made" was changed to "has not been issued by the executive director" for clarity and "the provisions of" was inserted after "violates" for consistency with standard drafting conventions.

TRA *Joint Favorable Subst.*

The following Fiscal Impact Statement and Bill Analysis are prepared for the benefit of the members of the General Assembly, solely for purposes of information, summarization and explanation and do not represent the intent of the General Assembly or either chamber thereof for any purpose. In general, fiscal impacts are based upon a variety of informational sources, including the analyst's professional knowledge. Whenever applicable, agency data is consulted as part of the analysis, however final products do not necessarily reflect an assessment from any specific department.

OFA Fiscal Note

State Impact:

Agency Affected	Fund-Effect	FY 27 \$	FY 28 \$
CT Airport Authority	General Aviation Airports Enterprise Fund - Revenue Gain	Approximately 3,750	Approximately 5,000
Judicial Dept. (Probation)	GF - Potential Cost	Minimal	Minimal
Resources of the General Fund	GF - Potential Revenue Gain	Minimal	Minimal

Note: GF=General Fund

Municipal Impact: None

Explanation

The bill results in revenue gain of approximately \$3,750 in FY 27 and approximately \$5,000 in FY 28 and annually thereafter to the Connecticut Airport Authority by making the following changes to aviation facility fees: (1) establishing a new \$100 registration fee for the approximately 34 smaller facilities in the state, and (2) increasing the existing license fee from \$150 to \$300 for the approximately 67 larger facilities in the state.¹

The bill also creates a new misdemeanor for operating a facility in violation of the bill's registration requirement, which results in a

¹ Both the registrations and licenses are effective for three years, and this estimate assumes that a roughly equal number of applications and renewals occur each year. The lower amount for FY 27 is due to the October 1, 2026, effective date.

potential cost to the Judicial Department for probation and a potential revenue gain to the General Fund from fines. On average, the marginal cost for supervision in the community is less than \$600² each year for adults and \$450 each year for juveniles.

The Out Years

The annualized ongoing fiscal impact identified above would continue into the future subject to the number of aviation facilities registered or licensed in the state, the number of offenses.

² Probation marginal cost is based on services provided by private providers and only includes costs that increase with each additional participant. This does not include a cost for additional supervision by a probation officer unless a new offense is anticipated to result in enough additional offenders to require additional probation officers.

OLR Bill Analysis**sSB 236*****AN ACT IMPLEMENTING THE RECOMMENDATIONS OF THE CONNECTICUT AIRPORT AUTHORITY REGARDING THE LICENSURE AND REGISTRATION OF AIRPORTS AND OTHER AIR NAVIGATION FACILITIES.*****SUMMARY**

This bill statutorily establishes a registration process for smaller air navigation facilities by:

1. specifying that existing law's licensing requirements for airports, heliports, vertiports, restricted landing areas, and other air navigation facilities only apply to those where more than 36 combined aircraft landings and takeoffs are expected in any year (see BACKGROUND);
2. explicitly authorizing the Connecticut Airport Authority (CAA) to register (and renew registrations for) facilities below this landings-takeoffs threshold; and
3. requiring that these facilities be registered with CAA before they are used or operated.

The bill sets a \$100 registration or renewal fee for these smaller facilities and makes registrations effective for three years. Under the bill, municipally owned or operated airports are not subject to registration fees. The bill requires registrants to certify, on a CAA-provided form, that (1) the facility will comply with all applicable federal, state, and local laws and regulations during the registration period and (2) there will be 36 or fewer combined aircraft landings and takeoffs at the facility in any year during the registration period.

Under the bill, it is a class C misdemeanor to operate a facility in

violation of the registration requirement (punishable by up to a \$500 fine, up to three months in prison, or both). The bill also applies this penalty to existing law's prohibition on operating a facility (that is above the landings-takeoffs threshold) without CAA first approving and licensing it. (As under existing law, these provisions do not apply to federally owned facilities.)

Additionally, beginning October 1, 2026, the bill increases the air navigation facility licensure or renewal fee (for facilities above the landings-takeoffs threshold) from \$150 to \$300. As under existing law, licenses are effective for three years.

Lastly, the bill makes minor, technical, and conforming changes.

EFFECTIVE DATE: October 1, 2026

BACKGROUND

Air Navigation Facility Licensing

Under existing law, any proposed air navigation facility (for example, airports and heliports) where more than 36 combined aircraft takeoffs and landings are expected in any year must be approved by CAA before the authority licenses it according to specified criteria demonstrating the facility will provide or currently provides for safe aircraft operations.

COMMITTEE ACTION

Transportation Committee

Joint Favorable Substitute

Yea 36 Nay 0 (03/16/2026)